

Payroll Processing Calendar 2026

Owner: Customer Support Operations. Applies to every Meridian Payroll customer on the standard funding schedule.

How the calendar works

Payroll must be approved in Meridian by **5:00 PM Eastern, two banking days before the pay date**. Approving by the cutoff guarantees that funds are debited one banking day before the pay date and that employees are paid by 9:00 AM local time on the pay date.

Payrolls approved after the cutoff are processed on the next banking day. The pay date moves with them unless the customer has Next-Day Funding enabled.

Next-Day Funding

Customers on the Plus and Enterprise plans can approve as late as **3:00 PM Eastern, one banking day before the pay date**. Next-Day Funding requires a completed bank verification and at least 90 days of clean payment history. Support can check eligibility on the customer's Billing page.

Holiday adjustments for Q4 2026

- **Thanksgiving week:** for a Friday, November 27 pay date the cutoff is **Tuesday, November 24 at 5:00 PM Eastern**, because Thursday November 26 is a Federal Reserve holiday.
- **Christmas:** for a Friday, December 25 pay date, the pay date moves earlier to Thursday, December 24, and the cutoff is **Monday, December 21 at 5:00 PM Eastern**.
- **New Year's Day:** for a Friday, January 1, 2027 pay date, the pay date moves to Thursday, December 31, and the cutoff is **Tuesday, December 29 at 5:00 PM Eastern**.
- Veterans Day (November 11) is a banking holiday: any cutoff that falls on it moves one banking day earlier.

Off-cycle payrolls

Off-cycle runs (bonuses, final paychecks, corrections) follow the same two-banking-day cutoff. For a same-day final paycheck required by state law (for example California or Colorado), direct the customer to issue a manual check and record it in Meridian as a manual payment; do not promise same-day direct deposit.

What to tell a customer who missed the cutoff

- 1 Confirm the approval timestamp on the payroll's History tab.
- 2 Offer to move the pay date to the next banking day, or offer Next-Day Funding if they are eligible.

- 3 If neither works, they can pay by manual check and record the payroll as manual. Never ask the customer for bank account numbers in chat.